because I broke this rule that he rejected "Half-Breed." It was because he saw an opportunity to demonstrate this rule that he was interested in "Homo Sol."

He did not quite explain this rule to me, and at that time I didn't thoroughly understand it and had no conscious intention of applying it. Nevertheless, when I got home I tore up the few pages I had done of "Homo Sol" and began all over again. By the end of the year, it was done.

On January 4, 1940, I visited him and submitted the story.

On that occasion, I met no fewer than three authors for the first time, all of whom were to be closely associated with Campbell in the decade just beginning.

One was Theodore Sturgeon, who had published two stories thus far, "Ether Breather" in the September 1939 Astounding, and "A God in a Garden" in the October 1939 Unknown. He was a mild, blond fellow with a thin, elfin face and soft blue eyes. He was a few years older than I was, but had gotten a later start.

Then there was L. Ron Hubbard, a well-established pulp writer whose first story in Astounding had been "The Dangerous Dimension" in the July 1938 issue, and whose two Unknown lead novels, "The Ultimate Adventure" in the April 1939 issue and "Slaves of Sleep" in the

July 1939 issue, I had enjoyed tremendously. He was a large-jawed, red-haired, big and expansive fellow who surprised me. His heroes tended to be frightened little men who rose to meet emergencies, and somehow I had expected Hubbard to be the same.

"You don't look at all like your stories," I said.

"Why? How are my stories?" he asked.

"Oh they're great" I said, enthusiastically and all present laughed while I blushed and tried to explain that if the stories were great and he was not like his stories, I didn't mean he was not great.

Finally there was Willy Ley, who had already published several nonfiction articles on rocketry in the magazine. He spoke with a thick German accent, which was, in itself, not calculated to endear him to me at the time, but he had left Germany as soon as Hitler had come into power and was a dedicated anti-Nazi. Besides, there was something lovable about him—a kind of intense but